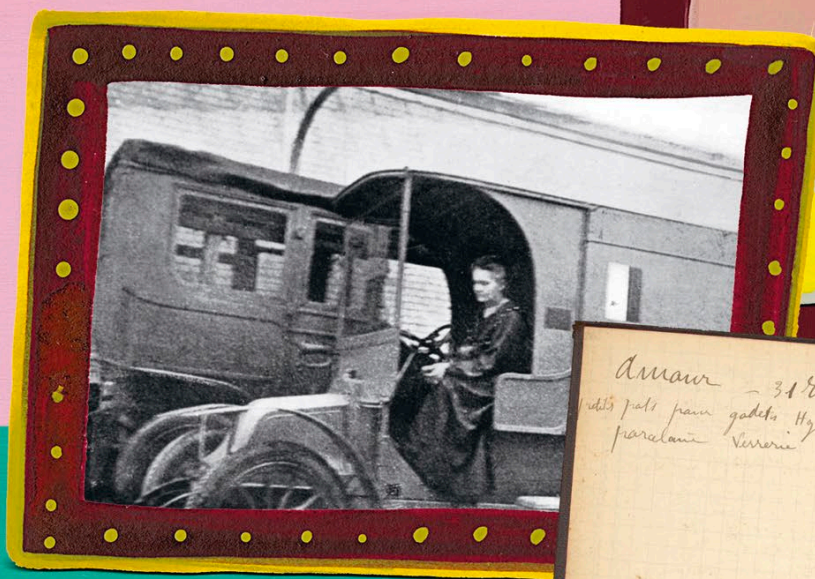


Radioactive rays

Over the next few years, other scientists found dozens of ways to use the intense radiation energy released by radium—from destroying germs in hospitals to getting rid of cancer, a serious illness, in patients. Marie, Pierre, and Henri won a Nobel Prize for Physics and became superstars. They could have made a fortune by selling their knowledge, but instead they decided to share it, to help other scientists with their work.

When Pierre was killed in a traffic accident, Marie was heartbroken, but she was determined to continue their quest to understand radioactivity and how it could be used to help people. She became the first person ever to win a second Nobel Prize—this time for chemistry. Her laboratory in Paris became one of the best places in the world to study radioactivity, and it helped many other women to become scientists. They included Marie's daughter Irene, who went on to win a Nobel Prize of her own!

During World War I, Marie raised money to set up the first mobile X-ray trucks. They could be driven to where they were most needed, helping to save lives.



Radiation can be harmful to those who work with it. Marie's work often made her very sick, and she died of cancer. Today, a charity named after her helps cancer patients. Its symbol is a daffodil.



*Amour - 31 rue des Lombards
cette fois pour gâcher H₂
paralysant l'urémie*

One hundred years after she last wrote in them, some of Marie's notebooks are still dangerously radioactive. They have to be kept in lead-lined boxes, which stop the radiation from passing through.

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